

1938, December 15

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

December 15th, 1938

Rev. M. E. Joachim Casey
Saint Anthony Monastery
Marathon, Wisconsin

My Dear Brother, Father Joachim:--

God bless you and I hope you are well--trying at least to be contented. I started to write you on the beautiful Feast of our Blessed Mother, the Immaculate Conception; being as it was the 42nd anniversary of the happy day of my vocation to St. Bonaventure's. Thanks be to God and the same His Blessed Immaculate Mother. As often happens, however, I did not get far with my letter that day; so now, before the octave passes, I'll try once more. This I've wanted to do out of gratitude for such a vocation to such an order and, I might say, especially for the grace of learning so quickly to love the Order--notwithstanding my prejudice on coming hither as I did, half against my will.

I offered my rosary this morning out in the crisp, moon-light air for your intentions and your guidance. I am confident that though, like the rest of us--poor children of Eve--you have your difficulties, your temptations, your falls even, and your occasional little triumphs, our dear Lord will keep you from serious blunderings. In fact, not only this, but notwithstanding your very sad blunderings in the past--possibly worse than my own, possibly not so bad--I still hope and pray that in the few years left us, you may do something to make up for lost time; something to save your soul and gain the one victory, the one crown, the only triumph really worthy a rational creature's every effort. The "few years" did I say??? Who can tell? We hope so, of course, if it be God's holy will; but O! How uncertain! ... it may be tomorrow they'll say of you or of me or of each of us: "He is gone."

If either of us live ten years longer it will be passing the old-age mark for our clan. And after all, what's the difference if we only be ready? Nay, if it be tomorrow or fifty years hence, if we only save our immortal souls? What's the difference?

But dear Father Maurice Joachim: I hardly know what to say or to think of your proposition to write back to your old